

or dishonestly making use of the electronic signature, password, or any other unique identification feature of a person.

4. Email spoofing

This is commonly used by hackers to hide the actual email address from which phishing and spam message are sent. It may also be used in conjunction with other fraudulent methods to trick users into providing personal/confidential information.

5. Sending offensive messages

The IT Act defines this offense as sending offensive or false information for the purpose of causing hatred, ill will, etc.

6. Voyeurism

This is defined as publishing/transmitting of “compromising” images/videos of a person without his/her consent.

7. Child pornography

This covers offences against all individuals who have not completed 18 years of age. Despite being one of the most serious offences, it does not attract any severe punishment

8. Cyber terrorism

The addition of this offence was a major difference between the two IT Acts. Cyber terrorism is described in fair detail as denying access to a computer, attempting to access a computer resource without authorization, or contaminating a computer system.



Punishment

While all other offences are punishable by imprisonment up to 3-5 years and/or a fine of up to ₹3-5 Lakh, an individual convicted of cyberterrorism is punishable by imprisonment for life.